

Good — that's a well-documented scene, so I can work from transcript sources plus what's known about the staging. Here's an analysis applying your PDF frameworks.

Scene: Emergency Boardroom Meeting (Margin Call, 2011)

1. Time (Chronemics) — the biggest power signal in the scene

The meeting is called in the **dead of night**, and Tuld arrives by helicopter hours after everyone else has been waiting. This is a textbook monochronic power move: in Doc 2's terms, controlling *when* a meeting happens (and making others wait for you) signals rank. Tuld even opens by apologizing for dragging everyone in at such an uncommon hour — acknowledging the disruption while doing nothing to soften his own lateness. The urgency of the hour also functions as **accenting**: it nonverbally underscores how severe the crisis is before a single technical detail is explained.

2. Space (Proxemics) & Artifacts — arrival as staging

A helicopter landing on the roof of a Wall Street building at 3am is pure **object/artifact language** — it says "I operate above the constraints everyone else in this room lives under." It's the corporate equivalent of the "public zone" entrance: he doesn't walk in through the same door as his employees.

3. Regulating — forcing the conversation down to his terms

This is the clearest nonverbal-communication concept in the whole scene. When Jared tries to explain using the report by referencing a specific page number, Tuld shuts it down and says he wants it explained in plain English — then turns to Peter Sullivan and delivers the now-famous line asking him to explain it as he might to a child or a golden retriever. In your framework, this is a **regulator** — Tuld is controlling not just who speaks, but at what level of complexity. It's also a subtle status display: only the most senior person in the room can openly demand simplification without looking incompetent himself.

4. Paralanguage — calm as dominance

Reports and the tone of his lines (measured, dry, almost bored) suggest Tuld speaks in a **low, unhurried register** even as everyone around him is panicking. Per your notes: a clear, firm, low-pitched voice reads as confidence and commands more attentive listening. His calm is doing real work here — it nonverbally reassures the room (or intimidates it) that he's already several steps ahead.

5. Kinesics — accenting through action language

Later, Tuld is described pounding on the desk while declaring "This is it!" — a clean example of **accenting**: a physical gesture landing exactly on the emotional peak of the verbal message, driving home finality/authority.

6. Eye contact as a deception/discomfort cue

When Tuld tells Sam the plan is so “that we may survive,” Sam is described as **lowering his gaze**. Per your deception/discomfort framework, this is a classic “leakage” cue — someone rationalizing something they know is ethically compromised, breaking eye contact not because they’re lying, but because they can’t hold the moral weight of what they’re agreeing to. It’s a nonverbal *contradiction*: Sam’s words (“I’ll do it”) don’t match what his eyes are doing.

7. Escalation up the hierarchy = shifting nonverbal registers

The structural joke of the scene (Marc Andreessen’s tweet about it, which is likely why this clip is circulating) is that **every escalation to a more senior person requires a simpler explanation** — Will → Sam → Jared/Sarah → Tuld. Each handoff is marked by a shift in posture, formality, and vocal register: junior analysts get more nervous, tense, and technical; senior executives get calmer, more clipped, and more informal/blunt. This directly maps to your “clusters” principle — nonverbal behavior isn’t just one cue, but a whole shifting package depending on who’s in the room.

One honesty note: I’m working from transcript excerpts and well-documented scene descriptions, not the actual visual footage, so I can’t comment with certainty on exact seating charts, specific facial expressions, or camera framing choices. If your assignment needs frame-level detail (e.g., “where exactly does X sit relative to Y”), you’ll want to verify against the actual clip.